

IT



INCLUDED ON THE
KS4 PERFORMANCE TABLES

Specification

Cambridge OCR Level 1/Level 2

Cambridge National in
IT

J836

Version 7 (First teaching September 2020)



ocr.org.uk/cambridgenationals



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About our new name

As of September 2025, our name is Cambridge OCR.

Students who sat an exam **in summer 2025** will receive a Cambridge OCR branded exam certificate (our new brand), which will be the same for all future exam series.

You'll continue to see the OCR or Oxford Cambridge and RSA Examinations name while we work to update our material to our new name, Cambridge OCR. This will take some time, and you can still access all up-to-date qualification resources and materials via [Teach Cambridge](#).

Important: We'll keep the OCR/Oxford Cambridge and RSA name on existing teaching resources while the content of these remains applicable to the specification being taught. **New and refreshed** resources will be produced using the Cambridge OCR name/logo.

Are you using the latest version of this specification?

The latest version of our specifications will always be on [our website](#) and may differ from printed versions. We will inform centres about changes to specifications.

Tell us what you think

Your feedback plays an important role in how we develop, market, support and resource qualifications now and into the future. We want you and your students to enjoy and get the best out of our qualifications and resources, but to do that we need your honest opinions to tell us whether we're on the right track or not.

You can email your thoughts to support@ocr.org.uk or visit our [feedback page](#) to learn more about how you can help us improve our qualifications.



Designing and testing in [collaboration with teachers](#) and students



Helping young people develop an [ethical view of the world](#)



Equality, diversity, inclusion and belonging (EDIB) are [part of everything we do](#)

Section 4.1.4: Performance Objectives	Updated weightings.	Version 2 (May 2022)
Section 4.4: Unit R070 Marking Criteria	Updated marking criteria for Topic Area 3: Creating an AR model prototype.	
Qualification overview Section 6.1.1: Centre and teacher/assessor responsibilities Section 6.2: Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR-set assignments Section 6.3: Feedback Section 6.4.4: Reattempting work before submitting marks to OCR	Updated to clarify information relating to NEA resubmissions.	
Section 6.5: Moderating NEA units	Updated information on how to submit moderated units.	
Section 6.6: Resubmitting moderated work to OCR to improve the grade Section 6.7: Recording feedback and decisions	New sections added to clarify information relating to NEA resubmissions.	
Section 7: Administration	Updated information to clarify administrative arrangements.	
Appendix A: Guidance for the production of electronic evidence	Updated information related to 'Submit for Assessment'.	
All	Weblinks updated.	
Section 4.2 unit R050: IT in the digital world	Teaching content 4.2: final bullet updated to Identity theft.	Version 3 (October 2022)
Section 2.1: Qualification overview	Updated to clarify information relating to Availability and Assessment method/ model.	Version 4 (August 2023)
Section 3.2: Language	Updated to clarify this qualification is available in English only and all candidate work must be in English.	
Section 3.3: Availability	New section added to clarify qualification is not available in Wales or Northern Ireland.	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/assessor responsibilities	Updated to clarify information relating to the availability of sample assessment material for practice purposes.	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/assessor responsibilities Section 6.2 Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR set assignments. Section 6.2.1 Ways to authenticate work Section 6.2.2 Plagiarism	Updated to include information relating to AI Use in Assessments	
Section 6.2 Requirements and guidance for delivering and marking the OCR set assignments	Updated to clarify information relating to availability of live assignments and making entries.	
Section 7.5.2 Making final unit entries	Updated to clarify information about making unit entries.	
Appendix A	Updated standard file formats table	

2.1 Qualification at a glance	Updated information on terminal assessment and exam resits	Version 5 (May 2024)
4.1.1 Terminal Assessment Rule	New section added to provide information on the terminal assessment rule	
5.1 Overview of the assessment	Updated to clarify the terminal rule	
6.3.7 Presentation of the final piece of work	Updated information on submission of work for moderation	
7.2 Collecting evidence of student performance to ensure resilience in the qualifications system	New section added to provide information on collecting evidence of student performance to ensure resilience in the qualifications system	
7.3 Entry rules, including Terminal Assessment	Updated to clarify information relating to entry rules and terminal assessment	
7.6 Making final entries	Updated to clarify use of component codes and digital submission of work for moderation	
All	Updated information to ensure compliance with new JCQ requirements and guidance.	Version 6 (September 2025)
All	References to 'Command words' have been replaced with 'Command and/or descriptor words', to cover both types of assessments. These are now called Descriptor Words for NEA units.	
Section 2	Included the lifespan for each set assignment and that live dates are shown on the front cover.	
Section 6	Improved clarity and guidance on: • use of the set assignment. • providing feedback to students. • resubmitting moderated work. Additional information provided to support the delivering and assessing of NEA units in line with JCQ instructions and guidance.	
Covers and all page footers	Updated to reflect the new Cambridge OCR brand. Inside cover includes statement: 'About our new name'.	

Throughout	Hyperlinks refreshed The following forms are now only available on Teach Cambridge : unit recording sheets (URS) and set assignment feedback form	Version 7 (June 2026)
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Aims	Updated to clarify that alternative software can be used to create a simulated AR experience.	
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Topic Area 3.1 Augmented Reality (AR) model prototype	Updated exemplification to clarify that an AR prototype will either demonstrate functional AR features or simulate the intended behaviour.	
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Topic Area 3.2 Triggers	Object recognition and Location based removed from the teaching content.	
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Topic Area 3.4 Information report	Animation added to the teaching content	
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Topic Area 4.1 Testing	User testing removed from the teaching content	
Section 4.4 Unit R070 Assessment guidance	Updated to clarify that alternative software can be used to create a simulated AR experience and what the expectations of a simulated AR experience are. Added guidance to clarify the evidence and assessment requirements for Task 2. Added assessment guidance for teaching content topic area 4.1	
Section 5.4 Grading and awarding grades	Updated to clarify on results day a marks calculator will be published for the specific series.	
Section 6.1.1 Centre and teacher/assessor responsibilities	Updated name of online training module and information about centre approval	
Section 6.2.2 Plagiarism (including AI misuse)	Updated to include more information relating to AI misuse in assessments and required teaching for referencing or acknowledging material copied from the internet or other sources.	
Section 6.3 Feedback	Add new section: <i>Informing students of their marks</i>	
Section 6.6 Resubmitting moderated work to us to improve the grade	Updated to clarify information relating to using work from a previous year's assignment	
Section 7.9 Post-results services	Updated access to scripts, which is a free service for exams officers to download copies of students' completed question papers	
Appendix C	Updated appendix title. Updated to clarify that alternative software can be used to create a simulated AR experience.	

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1 Why choose OCR?

Choose OCR and you've got the reassurance that you're working with one of the UK's leading exam boards. We have developed our specifications in consultation with teachers, employers and subject experts to provide students with a qualification that's relevant to them and meets their needs.

We're part of the Cambridge Assessment Group, Europe's largest assessment agency and a department of the University of Cambridge. Cambridge Assessment plays a leading role in developing and delivering assessments throughout the world, operating in over 150 countries.

We work with teachers, employers, and universities to create qualifications that support the needs of all students and help them prepare for their future. We offer A Levels, GCSEs, vocational qualifications, and other academic options to schools, colleges, workplaces, and other organisations.

1.1 Our specifications

We believe in developing specifications that help you bring the subject to life and inspire your students to achieve more. We've created teacher-friendly specifications based on extensive research and engagement with the teaching community.

They're designed to be straightforward and accessible so that you can tailor the delivery of the course to suit your needs.

1.2 Our support

We have a range of support services to help you at every stage, from preparation to delivery.

- A wide range of high-quality creative resources including resources created by leading organisations within the industry
- Textbooks and teaching and learning resources from leading publishers. For more information about all the published support for the Cambridge Nationals that has been endorsed by OCR please go to the [Cambridge Nationals page](#) on our website
- Professional development for teachers to fulfil a range of needs. To join our training (either face-to-face or online) or to search for training materials, please go to the [Professional Development page](#) on our website
- [Active Results](#) is our free results analysis service to help you review the performance of individual students or whole schools
- [ExamBuilder](#) is our free question-building platform that helps you to build your own tests using past OCR exam questions
- OCR subject advisors provide information and support to centres including specification and non-exam assessment advice, updates on resources developments and a range of training opportunities. They work with subject communities through a range of networks to share ideas and expertise to support teachers

Further help and support

Whether you are new to OCR or already teaching with us, you can find useful information, help and support on our [website](#). Or get in touch:

support@ocr.org.uk

@ocrextams

01223 553998

1.3 Aims and learning outcomes

Our Cambridge National in IT will encourage students to:

- understand and apply the fundamental principles and concepts of IT, including the use of IT in the digital world, Internet of Everything, data manipulation and Augmented Reality
- understand, apply and use IT appropriately and effectively for the purpose and audience
- develop learning and practical skills that can be applied to real-life contexts and work situations
- think creatively, innovatively, analytically, logically and critically
- develop independence and confidence in using skills that would be relevant to the IT sector and more widely
- plan, design, create, test and evaluate/review IT solutions and products which are fit for purpose and meeting user/client requirements and apply design and Human Computer Interface (HCI) considerations appropriate for a defined audience
- understand the impacts of digital technologies on the individual, organisation and wider society.

1.4 What are the key features of this specification?

The key features of OCR's Cambridge National in IT for you and your students are:

- a simple and intuitive assessment model, consisting of an externally assessed unit that focuses on knowledge and understanding and two skills-based, non examined assessment units (NEA)
 - a specification developed with teachers specifically for teachers. The specification lays out the subject content clearly
 - a flexible support package formed after listening to teachers' needs. The support package will help teachers to easily understand the requirements of the qualification and how it is assessed
 - a team of OCR Subject Advisors who support teachers directly and manage the qualification nationally
 - the specification has been designed to support progression onto Level 2 and Level 3 qualifications including Cambridge Technicals in Information Technology, Cambridge Technicals in Digital Media, Digital apprenticeships and Digital T levels.
- This qualification will help students to develop:
- a deep understanding in the use of IT in the digital world and how to apply design tools, principles of human computer interactions, the use of data and testing, cyber-security and legislation when creating an IT solution or product
 - technical skills which can be used to plan, design, create, test and evaluate/review IT solutions and Augmented Reality (AR) products that are appropriate for a defined target audience and meet requirements.

All Cambridge Nationals qualifications offered by OCR are regulated by Ofqual, the Regulator for qualifications offered in England. The qualification number for OCR's Cambridge National in IT is QN 603/7115/8.

Qualification overview